

GPA) or better in courses for which credit is given towards the graduate degree. Other than one grade of "C" being allowed in each program, no grades below "B" will be acceptable for graduate credit.

Program of Study

Each graduate student is required to prepare a program of study in consultation with his or her major advisor(s). A completed [Program of Study Form](#) must be received from each student by the start of the second semester of enrollment. Students who do not file a program of study within the specified deadline will not be allowed to register for the next term. Programs of study must include a detailed listing of the available options within each student's area of emphasis. Only under extreme circumstances and with adequate justification should changes be made to programs of study. All changes to programs of studies must have the approval of the student advisor, Department Chairperson and the Dean of the respective School.

All changes in the planned degree program must be made at least one semester prior to the student's application for graduation. Under no circumstances should a change in the program of study be requested for failing a required course.

Change of Program

Students who wish to change their major will complete an advising session with either the current program advisor or a program advisor for the intended major. The student will complete a [Change of Program Form](#) available on-line, which must be approved by the Program Advisor, Department Chairperson, and Dean of the School in which the student wishes to enroll. The signed application is sent to the Office of Graduate Studies for processing. All coursework regardless of major remain on the student's transcript and is used to calculate the grade point average.

Credit Hour Requirements

Candidates for a Master of Science degree must earn a minimum of 30 or more credit hours (CH), depending upon the specific degree requirements. Degree requirements are found in the graduate catalog currently in force at the time the student's degree plan was approved by the graduate dean. For most Master of Science degrees, 18 credit hours of the total 30 consist of core requirements and thesis.

Most M.Ed. degree programs are 30-36 semester hour programs. Students seeking licensure must meet all requirements as specified by the state, which may entail more than the minimum 30 credit hours. The specialist degree program is designed primarily to provide professional preparation for students involved in school-site administration and those individuals who have district-wide administrative responsibilities.

The Specialist degree program requires completion of a minimum of 36 graduate credit hours with the number of actual

credit hours a function of the previous educational background of each student and his or her goals.

The Doctor of Philosophy degree is the highest academic degree conferred by the university. The student who receives the Doctor of Philosophy must demonstrate proficiency in content matter of the chosen discipline. Students also must demonstrate the ability to critically evaluate work in the chosen field of study. The student must have shown ability to work independently in the field and must have made an original contribution to the advancement of knowledge. However, Ph.D. requirements vary among programs and change from time to time (For more details see specific requirements listed in this catalog under each degree program).

English Writing Proficiency

Each graduate student must demonstrate a minimum level of competency in written communication. Students may meet this requirement by:

1. Scoring a minimum 146 on the verbal section of the Graduate Record Examination.
2. Scoring 24 or more on the verbal section of the Graduate Management Admission Test for students entering the MBA Program.

Students who fail to obtain requisite scores on the GRE or GMAT are required to enroll in ENG 500 and pass the course with a grade of B or A.

Enrollment in ENG 500 is not a substitute for the GRE Verbal Exam. Nor is enrollment in the course a substitute for low GRE performance. Students who fail to obtain the requisite GRE scores are urged to take the GRE a second time. Failure to obtain requisite scores by the end of the first year of enrollment may lead to dismissal from Graduate Study.

However, in every case, the English Writing Proficiency requirement must be fulfilled during the student's first semester of enrollment. Students who fail to complete this requirement within the specified deadline will not be allowed to register for the next term unless permission is granted by the Dean of Graduate Studies.

Basic Mathematic Skills

Each graduate student must demonstrate a minimum level of competency in mathematics. Students may meet this requirement by:

1. Scoring a minimum combined (verbal and quantitative) score of 286 or a minimum 140 in the quantitative section of the Graduate Record Examination.
2. Scoring a combined score of 350 in the Graduate Management Admission Test for students entering the MBA Program.